EU tourism plan targets smoother rail, air and local transport links

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EU tourism plan targets smoother rail, air and local transport links
By Martina Sapio · Nov 4, 2026, 1:31 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — The European Commission’s first EU-wide tourism strategy will seek to make it easier to travel around Europe, while steering visitors toward less-frequented destinations and spreading demand across the year.

“We must encourage visitors to discover more of Europe in more places and throughout the year … and connectivity is essential to tourism,” Transport and Tourism Commissioner Apostolos Tzitzikostas said at Wednesday’s press conference presenting the strategy.

The plan would improve transport links to islands, coastal, rural and remote areas, including by upgrading infrastructure and supporting routes that the market does not provide.

The Commission wants to make tickets for rail and multimodal journeys easier to buy, improve high-speed and night train connections, and promote rail as part of the holiday experience. It also plans to revise air services rules, review airport legislation and make cross-border car rentals easier and more affordable.

The Commission will also look at whether local public transport tickets can work across borders, and study how taxis and private-hire vehicles can connect with other transport. It wants to make it easier to combine cycling routes such as EuroVelo with public transport.

The strategy proposes a cruise ship cooperation dialogue on sustainability, connectivity and managing visitor flows. It also points to stronger passenger rights and more accessible travel for people with disabilities or reduced mobility.

The Commission also says it will explore ways to help travelers identify flights that allow more than 100 milliliters of liquids on board.

The strategy is the Commission’s first EU-wide tourism policy.

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